

UNIT 9

Content Strategy

Creating for Two Audiences

Future of PMM Academy

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Overview

Content is how PMMs scale their influence. Great messaging means nothing if it never reaches buyers. This unit covers modern content strategy—building editorial engines that serve both human readers and AI systems, creating thought leadership that builds authority, and developing content operations that produce consistently without burning out.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this unit, you will be able to:

- Design content strategies that serve humans and AI systems simultaneously
- Build thought leadership programs that establish genuine authority
- Create sustainable content operations with AI assistance
- Measure content effectiveness beyond vanity metrics
- Develop editorial calendars aligned to buyer journey and business goals

Section 1: Content for Two Audiences

The Dual-Audience Reality

Every piece of content now serves two readers:

- **Humans:** Who evaluate, decide, and buy
- **AI Systems:** Who recommend, summarize, and cite

This isn't a future state—it's current reality. The content that gets cited in ChatGPT responses is the content that influences purchasing decisions made by people using AI as a research assistant.

What AI Systems Value

Different from traditional SEO, AI citation depends on:

Specificity Over Generality - Concrete numbers, dates, examples - Named sources and attribution - Specific methodologies and processes - Detailed implementation guidance

Structure Over Narrative - Clear hierarchies and organization - Logical section progression - Explicit relationship statements - Scannable format with clear answers

Freshness and Authority - Recent publication dates - Domain expertise signals - Consistent publishing history - Verifiable claims with sources

Balancing Both Audiences

The good news: human-valuable content is also AI-valuable. The optimizations that help AI (clarity, specificity, structure) also improve human comprehension.

Where they diverge:

- Humans appreciate narrative flow; AI prefers discrete facts
- Humans tolerate ambiguity; AI needs explicit statements
- Humans respond to emotion; AI processes information

The solution: structured content that humans can read and AI can parse.

Section 2: Thought Leadership That Works

What Thought Leadership Actually Is

Most "thought leadership" is neither. It's warmed-over industry trends with the company logo attached. Real thought leadership requires:

- **Original Thinking:** Ideas that aren't obvious or widely held

- **Evidence Base:** Data or experience supporting the perspective
- **Practical Application:** How to act on the insight
- **Genuine Risk:** Positions that some will disagree with

The Thought Leadership Trap

Many thought leadership programs fail because they try to: - Please everyone (controversial positions repel no one) - Stay safe (vanilla content doesn't spread) - Avoid expertise (general commentary vs. deep knowledge) - Over-produce (quantity without quality)

Building Thought Leadership Programs

Effective programs:

Start with POV - What do you believe that others don't? - What evidence supports this position? - What changes if people adopt this view?

Choose Distribution Wisely - One substantial piece beats ten thin ones - Owned channels (blog, newsletter) before rented (social, publications) - Build audience over time vs. chasing viral moments

Measure Influence, Not Just Reach - Citation in other content - Speaking invitations - Sales conversation mentions - Analyst and press references

Section 3: Content Operations

The PMM Content Challenge

PMMs create content across the entire buyer journey: - Awareness: Thought leadership, trend pieces, educational content - Consideration: Product comparisons, solution briefs, use cases - Decision: Competitive positioning, proof points, objection handling - Expansion: Customer success stories, advanced use cases

Doing this at scale without AI assistance is impossible—or requires unsustainable effort.

AI-Assisted Content Workflows

Research Phase - Competitive content audit - Topic gap analysis - Keyword and citation opportunity identification - Source aggregation and summarization

Creation Phase - First draft generation from outlines - Variant creation for segments/personas - Format adaptation (blog to social to email) - Editing and refinement assistance

Distribution Phase - Channel optimization - Scheduling recommendations - Performance prediction - A/B variant generation

Content Quality Control

AI assistance doesn't mean AI-generated slop. Quality control requires:

- Human review for accuracy and tone
- Fact-checking of AI-generated claims
- Brand voice consistency checks
- Competitive differentiation review
- Expert validation for technical content

Section 4: Editorial Planning

The Editorial Calendar

A functioning editorial calendar balances:

- **Business Priorities:** Launches, campaigns, strategic initiatives
- **Buyer Journey Needs:** Content for each stage
- **Seasonal Factors:** Industry events, budget cycles, holidays
- **Competitive Timing:** Responding to market moves
- **Resource Reality:** What can actually be produced

Calendar Architecture

Structure calendars in layers:

Strategic Layer (Quarterly) - Major themes and campaigns - Product launch content - Big-rock thought leadership - Research publications

Tactical Layer (Monthly) - Blog posts and articles - Social content themes - Email campaigns - Sales enablement pieces

Responsive Layer (Weekly) - News responses - Competitive updates - Customer requests - Trending topics

Content Atomization

One substantial piece should yield multiple assets:

- Long-form article →
 - Executive summary
 - Key statistics graphic
 - Quote cards for social
 - Email newsletter section
 - Sales talking points
 - Webinar content
 - Podcast episode

This isn't "repurposing"—it's planned atomization built into the original content brief.

Section 5: Measurement Beyond Vanity

What Actually Matters

Stop measuring: - Page views (empty without engagement) - Social impressions (visibility $\neq$ influence) - Email opens (unreliable and misleading)

Start measuring: - **Engagement Depth:** Time on page, scroll depth, interaction - **Progression:** Movement to next content or action - **Attribution:** Content in winning deal journeys - **Citation:** References in other content and AI responses - **Sales Utility:** Rep usage and feedback

Content Attribution Models

Content rarely drives direct conversion. More realistic models:

Journey Participation - Which content appears in winning deal journeys? - How early does content engage new accounts? - What's the typical content sequence before conversion?

Assist Value - How often does content appear before key conversion events? - What content accelerates deal velocity? - Which pieces correlate with larger deal sizes?

Qualitative Signals - Sales rep feedback on content utility - Customer mentions of specific content - Analyst and press citations

Key Takeaways

1. Content now serves two audiences—humans who decide and AI systems that recommend
2. Thought leadership requires original, evidence-based positions—not warmed-over trends
3. AI assistance enables content scale, but quality control remains human
4. Editorial calendars should layer strategic, tactical, and responsive content
5. Measure engagement depth and attribution, not vanity metrics

Assessment

Complete the Unit 9 assessment (10 questions, 80% to pass) to unlock the next unit.

Lab Exercise

Content Audit Lab: Use AI to audit existing content for AI visibility signals, identify gaps in buyer journey coverage, and build an editorial calendar with planned atomization for major pieces.